9.

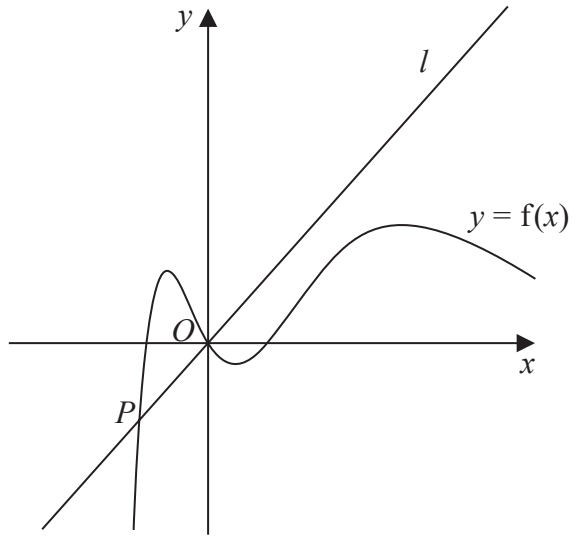


Figure 3

Figure 3 shows a sketch of part of the curve with equation $y = f(x)$, where

$$f(x) = x(x^2 - 4)e^{-\frac{1}{2}x}$$

(a) Find $f'(x)$.

(2)

The line l is the normal to the curve at O and meets the curve again at the point P.

The point P lies in the 3rd quadrant, as shown in Figure 3.

(b) Show that the x coordinate of P is a solution of the equation

$$x = -\frac{1}{2}\sqrt{16 + e^{\frac{1}{2}x}}$$

(4)

(c) Using the iterative formula

$$x_{n+1} = -\frac{1}{2}\sqrt{16 + e^{\frac{1}{2}x_n}} \quad \text{with } x_1 = -2$$

find, to 4 decimal places,

(i) the value of x_2

(ii) the x coordinate of P.

(3)